ENGLISH GUIDE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 2

LP2: 60% OF GCSE ENGLISH LANGUAGE (2.05HR)

2 NON-FICTION EXTRACTS



TIME: 5 MINUTES

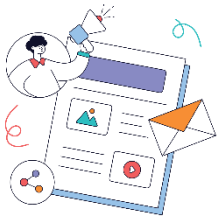
EXTRACT 1

Q1: COMPREHENSION - IDENTIFY... (2)

Q2: COMPREHENSION - GIVE TWO WAYS... (2)

TIME: 20 MINUTES

Q3: ANALYSE LANGUAGE AND STRUCTURE, 3 PARAGRAPHS, BEGINNING, MIDDLE, END (15)



TIME: 5 MINUTES

EXTRACT 2:

Q4: COMPREHENSION - IDENTIFY... (1)

Q5: COMPREHENSION - IDENTIFY... (1)

TIME: 20 MINUTES

EVALUATE, 3 PARAGRAPHS, 3 IDEAS, EVALUATIVE LANGUAGE EG. POWERFULLY (15)

TIME: 10 MINUTES

EXTRACT 1 AND 2:

Q7A: SYNTHESISE - COMPARING SIMILARITIES IN THE CONTENT ONLY, 3 PARAGRAPHS, BOTH TEXTS SHOW... (6)

TIME: 25 MINUTES

Q7A: SYNTHESISE - COMPARING SIMILARITIES AND DIFFERENCES, LANGUAGE AND STRUCTURE, 2-3 PARAGRAPHS, IN TEXT 1, THE WRITER PRESENTS THE IDEA THAT, WHEREAS IN TEXT (14)

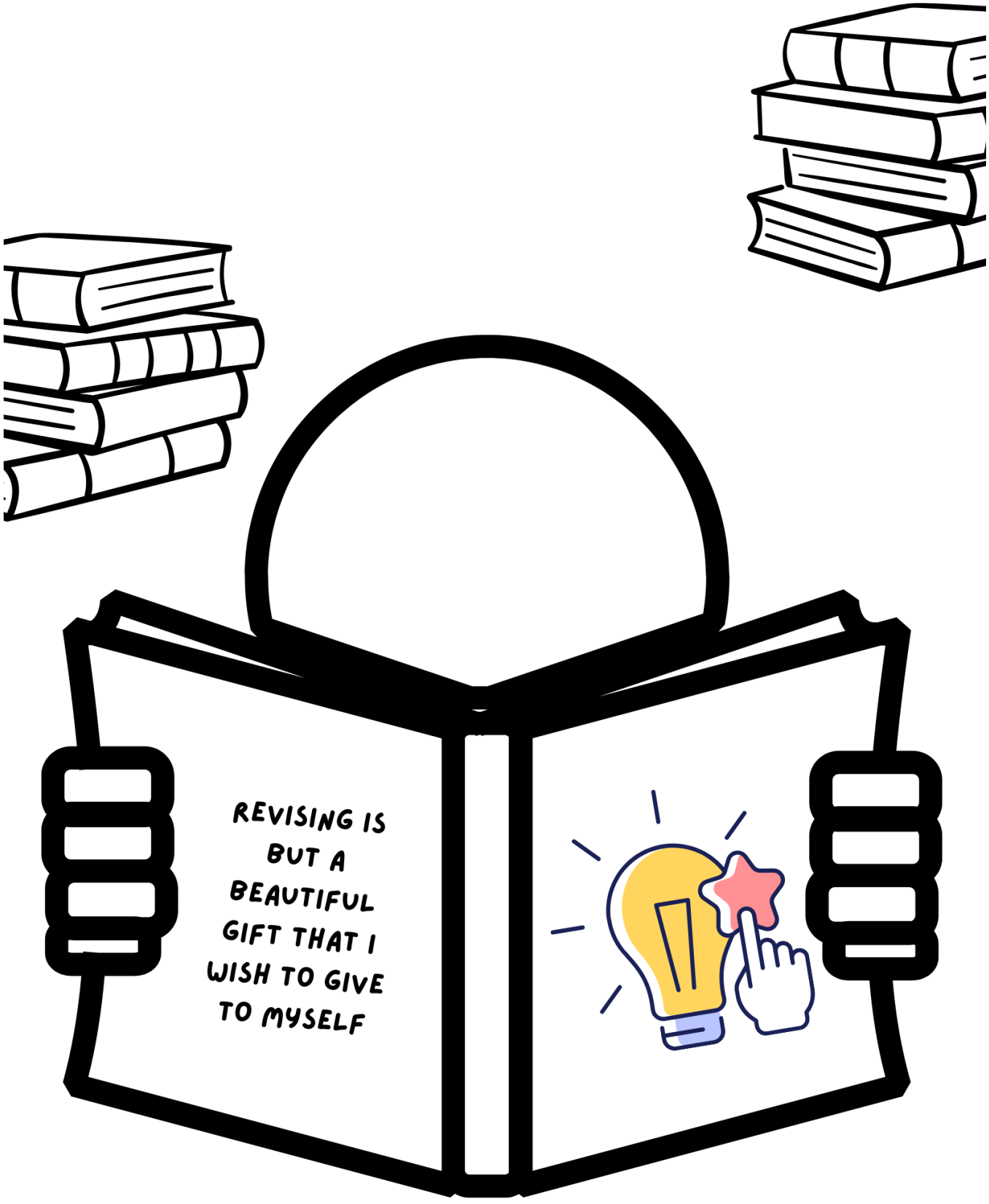
TIME: 40 MINUTES

Q8 OR 9: TRANSACTIONAL WRITING, 3-4 PARAGRAPHS (40)

TOTAL MARKS = 96

TOTAL TIME: 2HR05MIN

PART A: READING SECTION



EXTRACT 1

You discover, for instance, the secrecy attached to poverty. At a sudden stroke you have been reduced to an income of six francs a day. But of course you dare not admit it–you have got to pretend that you are living quite as usual. From the start it tangles you in a net of lies, and even with the lies you can hardly manage it. You stop sending clothes to the laundry, and the laundry worker catches you in the street and asks you why; you mumble something, and she, thinking you are sending the clothes elsewhere, is your enemy for life. The tobacconist* keeps asking why you have cut down your smoking. There are letters you want to answer, and cannot, because stamps are too expensive. And then there are your meals–meals are the worst difficulty of all. Your food is bread and margarine, or bread and wine, and even the nature of the food is governed by lies. You have to buy rye bread instead of household bread, because the rye loaves, though dearer**, are round and can be smuggled in your pockets. This wastes you a franc a day. Sometimes, to keep up appearances, you have to spend money on a drink, and go correspondingly short of food. Your linen gets filthy, and you run out of soap and razorblades. Your hair wants cutting, and you try to cut it yourself, with such fearful results that you have to go to the barber after all, and spend the equivalent of a day's food. All day you are telling lies, and expensive lies.





EXTRACT 2

After we were flooded four times in five weeks, Westminster environmental health found three inches of standing water under the floor, which was why we had the chronic damp. The housing association didn't fix it. Instead, we were evicted.

Becoming homeless again was something I had been so fearful about. But I'd assumed if I worked hard, went to university and got a job it would not happen to me again. But it did. By then, I was working and my sister had graduated and got a job. Yet we were homeless in 2013 for 18 months, placed in a series of hotels (often with no laundry, no Wi-Fi, no fridge) for a couple of weeks at a time before being moved on. It is exhausting and expensive not having a permanent space, and so hard to focus on your job. I set out to investigate the phenomenon of working people who are homeless because working is sold as the route out of homelessness. It should be a guarantee that you are not at risk of becoming homeless.

Language Paper 2: Section A (Reading)
Extract-based Questions



EXTRACT 1 : ANALYSIS

Developed explanation and analysis of language and structure devices
2-3 paragraphs, beginning middle and end
Include a reader's response

SENTENCE STARTERS

At the beginning the extract... (link to question, what is the writer doing that answers the question?)
The writer says "..."
The use of _____ (insert device) implies...
The writer positions the reader to feel...

MODEL

At the beginning of the extract, the writer engages the reader when describing the issues surrounding food when you are homeless, through the detailed examples and clear experience with struggling for food. The writer describes how "the food is governed by lies". The metaphor demonstrates that food is controlled by a higher power, demonstrating the lack of freedom you have when you are homeless. The verb 'governed' demonstrates an institutional control over items as everyday as bread. The writer uses the example of not having "rye bread" and instead only being able to eat "household bread". The juxtaposition between these distinctively different types of bread, shows the stark contrast between the rich and the poor, thus highlighting the suffering of homeless people. The reader is interested as they have similarly can buy bread and so can fully understand the everyday example of what sort of food you are able to afford as a homeless person.

EXTRACT 2: EVALUATE



Explore the setting, event and character
give a judgement on what the writer has done well
include a reader response

SENTENCE STARTERS

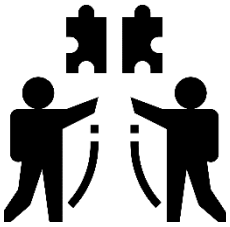
The writer successfully...
The writer effectively conveys...
This cleverly demonstrates...
The writer powerfully positions the reader to feel...

Model (setting):

The writer successfully demonstrates the horrific setting that homeless people are forced to live in when provided with accommodation. The writer cleverly describes the issues with the living conditions, specifically the accommodation having "flooded 4/5 times per week" with caused, the "chronic damp" and the refusal of the council to "fix it". The issue is powerfully shown to be reoccurring at a high intensity, to the point where the effects are long term – like damp. The writer therefore subtly implies the ongoing problems with temporary accommodation and the inability of the council to provide sufficient help and support, leaving homeless people defenceless and stuck in dangerous flooded and damp homes. The writer therefore positions the reader to feel sympathetic for the writer who is clearly struggling to live, even when placed in a home. This demonstrates the negative long-term effects of homeless people within society when placed into unfit accommodation.







Language Paper 2: Section A (Reading)
Extract-based Questions
EXTRACT 1 AND 2 COMPARISON

7A: Comparison of similarities between Text 1 and Text 2

Short description of what is similar, including a quotation from each text to prove your point

SENTENCE STARTERS

Both texts are similar because...
Text 1 says...
Whilst, Text 2 describes...

MODEL

Both writers describe the inability to wash their clothes. Text 1 states "Stop sending clothes to the laundry", whilst text 2 claims they could do "no laundry". Therefore, both texts show how the writers are unable wash their items.

7B: Comparison of similarities and differences between Text 1 and Text 2

A comparison between both similarities and differences
Analyse structure or language
Compare point of view, perspective and tone

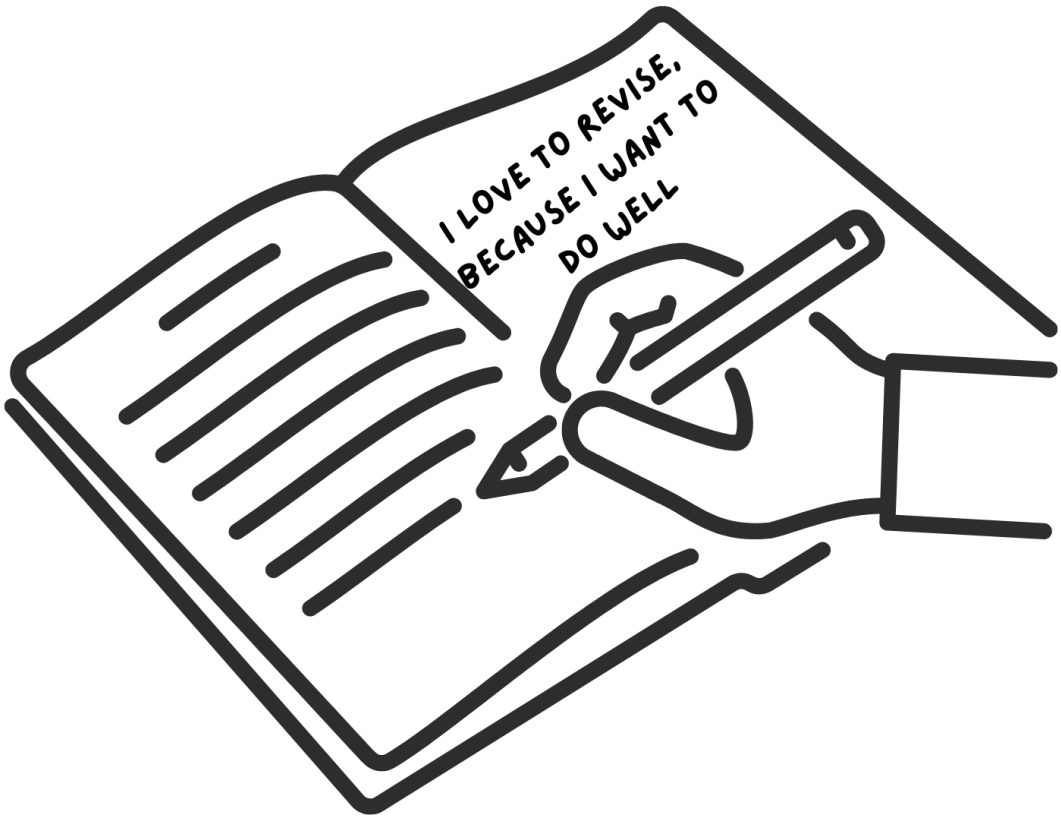
SENTENCE STARTERS

Both writers describe...
In contrast...
However...
Therefore both texts are similar because
Therefore both texts are difference because

Model:

Both writers describe the inability to wash their clothes. Text 1 states "Stop sending clothes to the laundry". The imperative verb "stop" suggests a sudden and abrupt end to the privilege of washing your clothes. Text 2 similarly claims they could do "no laundry". The imperative "no" implies an longstanding inability to wash their clothes. Therefore Text 1 demonstrates that until recently they were able to do laundry and now this has suddenly ended, however in text 2 the lack of clothes washing is a reoccurring issues dependent upon the accommodation they are in. This means that both texts are similar and so show how the writers are unable wash their items, yet this is not a permanent and reoccurring issue for Text 1 like it is for Text 2.

PART B: WRITING SECTION



Transactional Writing Writing Format

FORMAL LETTER



Begin with
'Dear' and then the person's name eg.
Dear Miss Brown

End with 'Kind regards' or 'Yours sincerely'
followed by your name eg.
'Kind regards,
Miss Miller'



INFORMAL LETTER

Begin with
'Dear' and then the person's name eg.
Dear Miss Brown,

End with 'Best Wishes' or 'Many thanks'
followed by your name eg.
'Many thanks,
Miss Miller'

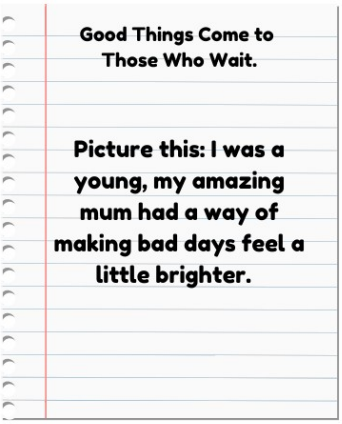




Article

Include: A title
Usually formal

Begin with 'Picture this:' and use an
anecdote to show your opinion



Transactional Writing Writing Format



Good Things Come to Those Who Wait.

REVIEW / BLOGPOST

Like an article, but more chatty and informal

Begin with 'Picture this:' and use an anecdote to show your opinion



Picture this: you've not had the best day, and you're not feeling great, well I can tell you how to turn things around!

Speech

No features expected.
Be forceful with your opinion!

Begin with 'Picture this:' and use an anecdote to show your opinion

Good Things Come to Those Who Wait.

Picture this:
everyone's real dream as a child is to grow up to be rich but we know now that money is what's important.



Leaflet/booklet/guide

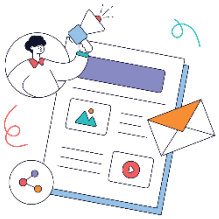
Include: A title
Usually formal

Present some information using bullet points.
No features expected

How to create a happy life, and give back to others.

Step one: Find kindness in your heart and remain open minded.

Step two:



Language Paper 2: Section B (Writing)
Transactional Writing

PARAGRAPH 1

Use an anecdote (short story) to demonstrate your opinion
Variety of sentence lengths
Variety of punctuation

SENTENCE STARTERS

Picture this:
One afternoon...
This moment taught me...

MODEL

Picture this: I was a kid, and my amazing mum had a way of making bad days feel a little brighter. One afternoon, after I came home from school upset over a poor grade, she handed me a chocolate bar. It wasn't extravagant or elaborate, but it was enough to shift my focus. That small, thoughtful gesture reminded me that even on difficult days, there's always something to appreciate.

Paragraph 2

Expalin in detail using statistics, facts, questioning exactly what your anecdote means and what your opinion is and why

SENTENCE STARTERS

This moment taught me...
The problem is...
Studies show that...

Model:

This moment taught me an important lesson: joy often comes from the small, everyday moments we overlook. Whether it's a simple treat, a kind gesture, or a moment of peace, life offers countless reasons to feel grateful. The problem is, many of us get so caught up in chasing big milestones and solving life's challenges that we fail to notice the beauty in the ordinary. Studies show that 70% of people believe that recognizing and appreciating small moments can improve their own mental health, reduce stress, and enhance overall happiness.

Paragraph 3

Conclude your main points by giving a solution as to how people can achieve your advice, or move away from something you think is wrong

SENTENCE STARTERS

We must... (try to use anaphora)

Model:

Life's small celebrations add up to something far greater, so take the time to notice them. Even a seemingly trivial gesture, like receiving a chocolate bar, can carry a deeper meaning if we choose to let it. We must learn to celebrate all the good in our lives, no matter the importance. We must exuberate positive energy to receive the reward of a happy and pleasant life in return.